

Creating Opportunities

Developing your own Marketing Plan

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Agenda

- ☐ **Start with mapping your Capabilities, Competencies, & Expertise**
- ☐ **Identify Unmet Needs with a potential Job & Leverage Creative Thinking**
- ☐ **Showcase Your Expertise, But Sell Your Potential**
- ☐ **Think like an entrepreneur but act like a leader**
- ☐ **Creating your Personal Marketing Plan**
- ☐ **Build a 4-Step Plan for Creating Opportunities**

About your presenter



- ❑ Worked for over 12 large organizations
- ❑ Escaped 2 buyouts
- ❑ Survived 3 mgmt transitions
- ❑ Was laid off by 4 organizations
- ❑ Reshaped his career with every move in the journey
- ❑ Learned how to build on his strengths
- ❑ Learned how to adapt to the market, and sell value

The New Reality

- ☐ Most of the jobs that were cut in this last recession are gone...companies have learned how to survive
- ☐ The cost of education is beyond the reach of the average person
- ☐ An education no longer guarantees a promotion (let alone a job)
- ☐ Double-Digit unemployment may be the new norm for this country...

But, there are opportunities out there

- ☐ Many companies are struggling to grow
- ☐ Our governments and society will be facing some very large problems
- ☐ Healthcare is a problem that needs new solutions
- ☐ Education is a solution that has many problems

Opportunities ☒

**START WITH MAPPING YOUR CAPABILITIES,
COMPETENCIES, & EXPERTISE**

Using a 3 Step Approach

- ❑ Many of us have experienced the challenges with career changes and restarts that result in lost time and wages (to say nothing of lowering the standard of living). The problem and solution is as simple as 1-2-3.

1. Education

2. Experience

3. Expertise

Step 1: Education

- ❑ Education is the starting point where we acquire capabilities and knowledge. If we're sufficiently adept, we learn how to apply knowledge quickly. But, no one is going to pay you very much for having knowledge. This is where we jump to #2.



Step 2: Experience

- ❑ Experience is where you apply the capabilities you acquired and develop competencies. These competencies are where you can earn money. The more competencies you have the more “jobs” you can perform, so there are more opportunities to earn money. But, it’s hard to make significant amounts of money unless you become really good or are fortunate enough to climb the ladder (much tougher these days). That’s where we jump to #3.



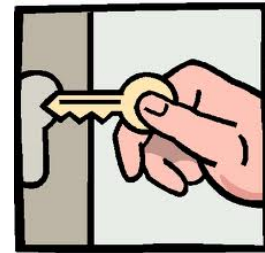
Step 3: Expertise

- ❑ **Expertise is when you develop deep skills within one (or more) competencies. These folks are typically professionals who have obtained lots of on-the-job experience and are called upon to solve the toughest challenges and/or provide services that only come with years of practice and supervision. (e.g. Doctors, Lawyers, Engineers, Scientists, and Senior Researchers).**



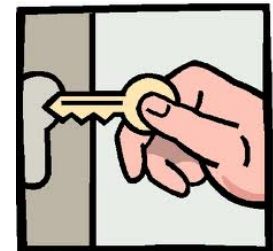
Scenario: The “endless” loop

- ❑ When folks lose their jobs, in many cases they have to go back to #1 and get re-trained. This disrupts their ability to retain their income level and creates additional challenges for folks since they don't have clear direction on which capabilities they need to acquire. Further, they may go into debt (which they can ill afford) in order to pay for the education.



Breaking Tradition

- ❑ A better option is for folks to fall back on #2 and find new ways of leveraging their competencies. This way the step-down is not as long or as deep on their income levels. However, this requires careful planning up front to ensure you have the right kinds of experience to develop a wider base of competencies, which allows you to perform a variety of different jobs and make a lateral move instead of “starting over”.



Skills Tracking

10 min.

EXERCISE



EXERCISE MORE

Leave the conveniences behind.

IDENTIFY UNMET NEEDS WITH A POTENTIAL JOB & LEVERAGE CREATIVE THINKING

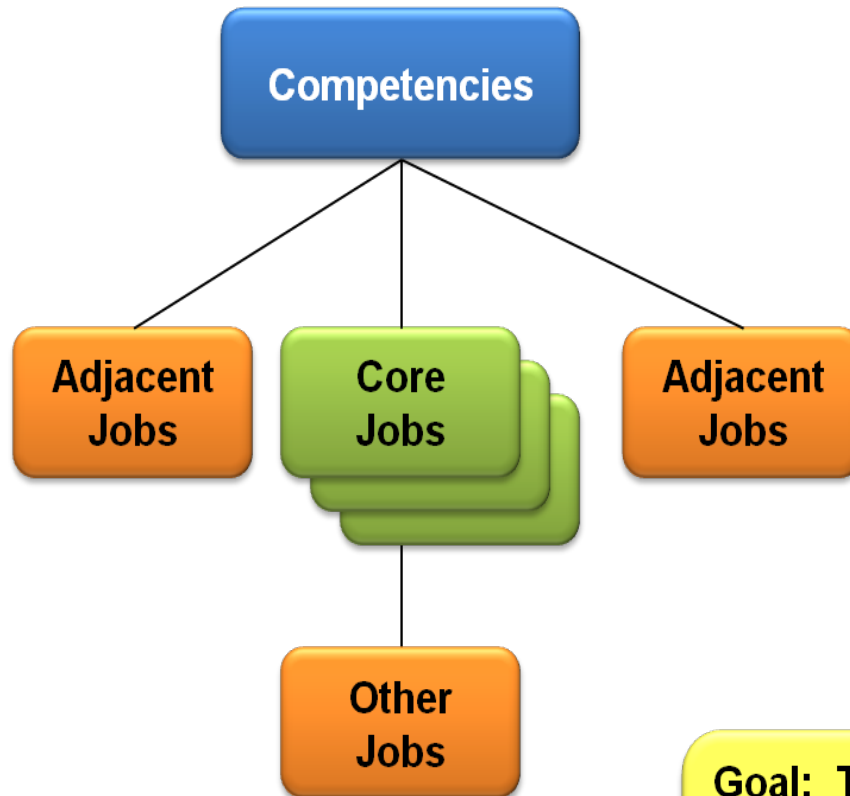
Creative thinking is essential

- ☐ **So, the door in front is closed...what do you do ?**
 - I've done job (xxx) for so long...now what ?
 - I've been out of the workforce for years...
 - My skills are no longer needed...what's my next step ?
 - I've tried to find jobs in my field, but there are none !

- ☐ **We all have transferrable skills**

- ☐ **The key is to find creative ways of applying them**

Identify new career opportunities

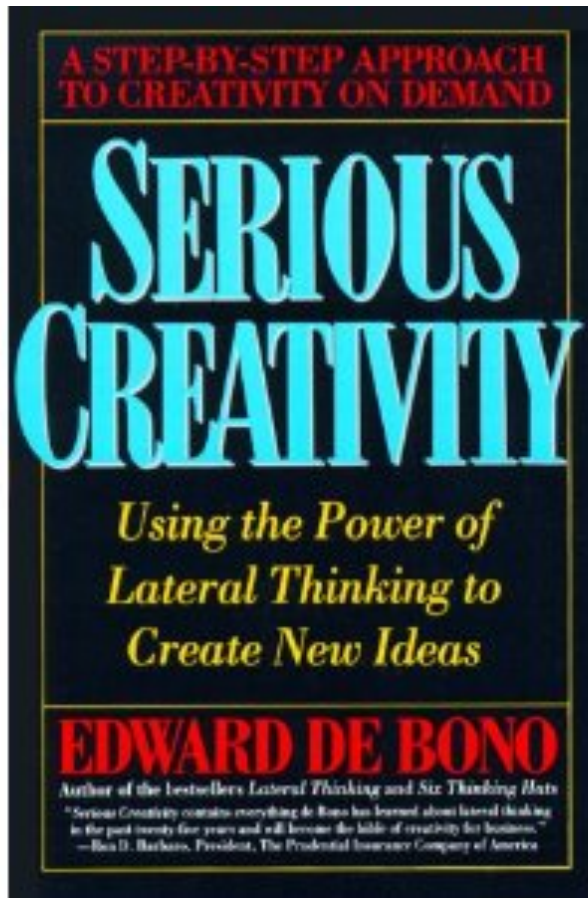


Once you identify your competencies, you can map them to one or more Jobs.

This creates more options for your job search & more career opportunities overall.

Goal: Try to find a job that leverages the competencies that you most enjoy using (or would like to develop).

Everyone Has Creative Potential



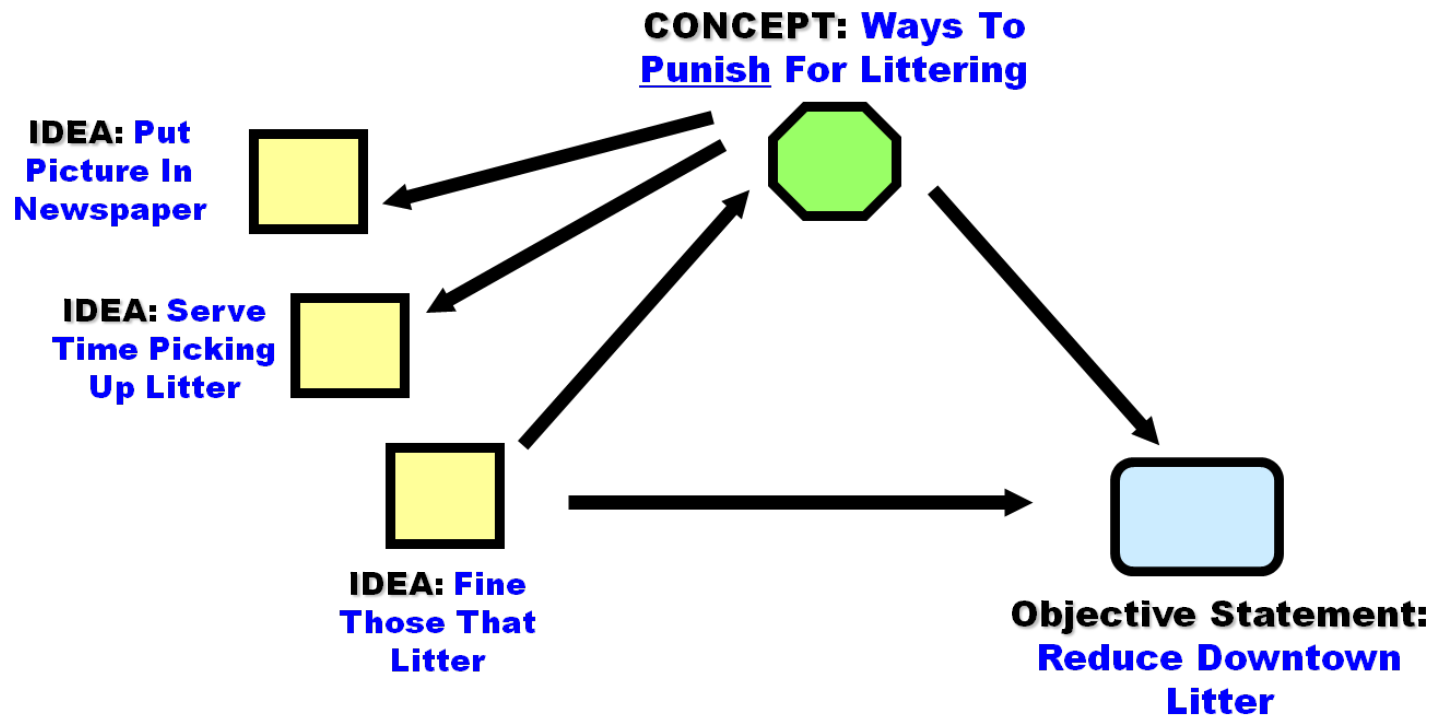
- ☐ We're all born with innate curiosity about the world.
- ☐ But, we were never provided with the training to develop those skills further.
- ☐ There are proven methods & techniques that can be learned.

Introducing the Concept Fan

1. *What is the concept behind the idea?*

2. *Are there any other ways to carry out that concept?*

3. *Are there any other concepts?*



Concept Fan in Motion

OBJECTIVE:

Generate ideas on how to make sticky notes more popular

Ways to more easily transport sticky notes after writing

Ways to make it easier for sender to clearly indicate something

Ways to have sticky notes indicate something in a unique and fun way

Ways to provide more flexibility to the user

Ways to use shapes to indicate something or enhance the message

Ways to better organize the sticky notes after they are written

Ways to use texture to indicate something or enhance the message

Emboss an image to match the fragrance on the note

Create a small book with clear plastic pages to store notes for travel

Print a blank smiley face on the note so sender can indicate an emotion

Add scents & colors to help get message across - scratch & sniff!!!

This offer seems a little fishy if you ask me!



Putting this new skill to work

- ❑ **Ok, let's define the problem statement:**
 - Ways to apply your competencies in “other” jobs.
- ❑ **Next, we're going to refine the problem statement by selecting 1-3 competencies**
 - Select 1-3 skills that you are really good at and that you really enjoy using. (**expertise & passion**)
- ❑ **Now, let's leverage the lateral thinking (which we briefly discussed) to come up with ideas for other jobs we may want to pursue.**

Creative Thinking

10 min.

EXERCISE



I'll need a volunteer 😊

**SHOWCASE YOUR EXPERTISE, BUT SELL YOUR
POTENTIAL**

Preparing for interviews or a new venture

- ❑ **Before you jump in to your job search or consider starting a new business...**

- ❑ **Make sure you are ready to sell yourself effectively:**
 - What you know
 - What you can do, and
 - What you can bring to the table (above and beyond)

Talk about your accomplishments

- ❑ Your expertise is only known to those who've you have served (organizations and/or customers).
- ❑ The goal is to showcase them by talking about past accomplishments:
 - When did these occur ?
 - What did you do ?
 - How did you do it (this is where expertise comes in) ?
 - What was the impact (all about results) ?

Position yourself to sell potential

- ❑ **Study the organization in advance**
 - Almost all are struggling somewhere (many everywhere)...
- ❑ **Review the job description and compare it to others**
 - Think beyond the job where you might be able to contribute
- ❑ **Identify a few key scenarios where your expertise can be leveraged (potential)**
 - Where can you help the hiring manager ?
 - What would a very successful year look like ?

**THINK LIKE AN ENTREPRENEUR BUT
ACT LIKE A LEADER**

A little about “innovation”



- ❑ “We’ve got to lead the world in innovation”
- President Obama
“State of the Union 2011”

IDEAS + Customer Needs = Value to the Customer



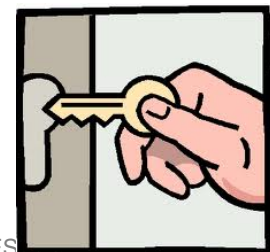
Innovation Reference Material

- ❑ **Article: Clayton Christensen on capturing what customers want from products**
 - <http://hbswk.hbs.edu/item/5170.html>

- ❑ **Article: Dorothy Leonard (HBS) on turning customer input into innovation**
 - http://bus6900.alliant.wikispaces.net/file/view/HBR_Turn+customer+input+into+innovation.pdf

Bring a fresh perspective to the table

- ❑ **Most folks approach an interview by trying to bring solutions to the table before they fully understand the problem**
 - Actually, the same occurs when business folks approach customers
- ❑ **Shift your focus from solution/product focus to one that is Outcome focused**
- ❑ **Try to understand the job or business problem to be solved from the perspective of the customer.**



Using Outcome Driven Thinking

- ❑ **Think about the job that a hiring manager is trying to get done**
 - Read the description and listen to her/his needs
 - Find out what the success criteria is for the job

- ❑ **Consider what the desired outcomes would look like for those “internal/external” customers who receive YOUR services**
 - Sometimes the job description doesn’t always match the job that NEEDS to get done (opportunity)
 - Sometimes the hiring manager brings too narrow of a focus to the job (opportunity)

Create “Peak” moments

❑ Leverage Appreciative Inquiry to create “Peak” moments in conversations

- Peak moments occur when you can position yourself as the solution to a problem
- Peak moments occur when you can get the other party to think differently about a problem or the way they think about solving a problem
- Peak moments occur when you can get people to think differently about the way they perceive you

Scenario of Outcome Driven Thinking

10 min.

EXERCISE



CREATING YOUR PERSONAL MARKETING PLAN

Create a game plan

- ☐ Find your Passion
- ☐ Define your strengths
- ☐ Identify your transferrable skills
- ☐ Develop your network
- ☐ Don't set any Limits
- ☐ Leverage your creativity
- ☐ Conduct informational interviews
- ☐ Pursue your opportunities

Taking the first steps

- ☐ **Start with mapping your Capabilities, Competencies, & Expertise**
- ☐ **Next, use your creative thinking to discover new ways to promote the value that you can offer.**
- ☐ **Revise your resume**
 - Promote your capabilities (knowledge and acquired skills)
 - Highlight your competencies (applied capabilities => experience)
 - Sell you're accomplishments

Taking the first steps...

- ☐ **Start with mapping your Capabilities, Competencies, & Expertise**
- ☐ **Identify Unmet Needs with a potential Job & Demonstrate Creative Thinking**
- ☐ **Showcase Your Expertise, But Sell Your Potential**
- ☐ **Think like an entrepreneur but act like a leader**
- ☐ **Build a 4-Step Plan for Creating Opportunities**

Market Like a Pro

- ❑ **Promote your potential and the value that you can deliver so you can position yourself for one or more core jobs (which align with our direct experience) and adjacent / other jobs (which allow you to leverage competencies and one or more capabilities).**
 - Think about using LinkedIn
 - Consider creating a Facebook page or Website that promotes your competencies
 - Leverage Twitter and/or setup a Blog to promote the way you think & your knowledge

Social Networking Tools

Personal Website:

- Bio
- Video
- Accomplishments
- Knowledge Sharing

LinkedIn:

- Bio
- Accomplishments
- References
- Work History
- Connections

Twitter:

- Short Messages (140 chars)
- What's going on (now)
- Video streaming
- Advertising

Slide Share:

- Knowledge Sharing
- Education
- Best Practices
- Promotion (self/knowledge)
- Marketing

YouTube:

- Education
- Information
- Entertainment
- Promotion

Facebook:

- Personal Connections
- Ads
- Personal attributes
- Character insights *
- Business Websites
- Connections & Reach

*** Be Careful...can be used to filter you for job (current or future)**

4-STEP PLAN FOR CREATING OPPORTUNITIES

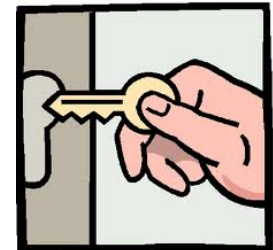
4-Step Plan for Creating Opportunities

- ❑ **Start with the JOB – Try to understand the steps someone would go through to perform the “core” job.**

- ❑ **Think about the competencies you might need to perform the core job and what additional competencies you might need to go beyond that job and complete “adjacent” jobs.**
 - A Core Job might be providing Legal review of contracts.
 - An Adjacent Job might be negotiating pricing or guiding Product Managers with planning a release schedule for a product that is part of a negotiated deal.

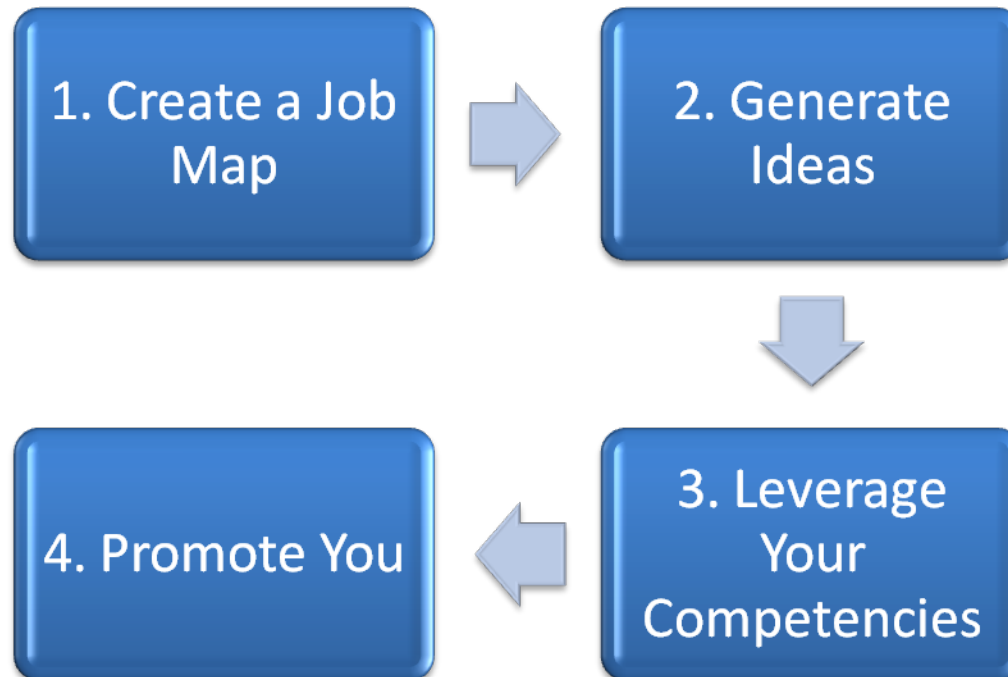
4-Step Plan for Creating Opportunities

- ❑ Next, apply some Lateral Thinking (creative thinking technique) to explore ways you could leverage your competencies and capabilities to fulfill the core job and any adjacent jobs.
- ❑ Once you have a list of ideas (from step 2), you can think about creating one or more “solutions” where you can apply your competencies to address the desired outcomes for the core job and adjacent jobs.



4-Step Plan for Creating Opportunities

- ❑ Now, you're ready to sell yourself more effectively by presenting a better value proposition than other candidates.



Quick Review

- ✓ **Start with mapping your Capabilities, Competencies, & Expertise**
- ✓ **Identify Unmet Needs with a potential Job & Leverage Creative Thinking**
- ✓ **Showcase Your Expertise, But Sell Your Potential**
- ✓ **Think like an entrepreneur but act like a leader**
- ✓ **Creating your Personal Marketing Plan**
- ✓ **Build a 4-Step Plan for Creating Opportunities**

Closing thoughts....

**“Alone we can do so little,
together we can do so much”**

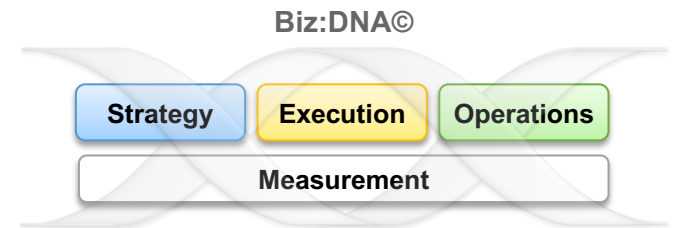
- Helen Keller

**The future will be defined by how
well we can collaborate**



Thank You

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